



Bulguksa Temple

Silla crown

In the Silla capital, Gyeongju, kings were buried in tombs covered with mounds of rocks. The tombs contained rich treasures, such as gold crowns decorated with antler or tree shapes.



Bulguksa Temple

The kingdom of Silla started following the Buddhist religion in 527 CE. The Bulguksa Temple was built in Gyeongju, the royal capital, in 751–774 CE. Bulguksa means “temple of the land of Buddha.”

Coastal kingdoms

Korea is an area of land that sticks out from Asia into the Pacific Ocean. It traded a lot with nearby China.



Ancient Korea

By the first century BCE, there were three competing kingdoms in Korea. Goguryeo was a large kingdom in the north; Baekje was in the southwest; and Silla was in the southeast. There was also a group of independent cities in the south called Gaya. Silla conquered the other kingdoms in 668 CE, but modern Korea took its name from the kingdom of Goguryeo.